

AMENDMENT 0001 15DDHQ-26-RFI-FAIT03: RESPONSE TO QUESTIONS

The period for questions has now closed. The following questions have been received and the answers are below.

As a result, the due date for RFI submissions is hereby changed:

From: April 27, 2026 at 2pm Eastern Time

To: May 1, 2026 at 2pm Eastern Time

Corporate Transparency and Ownership Depth

1. To what extent will the evaluation prioritize the ability to unmask Ultimate Beneficial Owners (UBOs) through five or more layers of corporate shielding, particularly within jurisdictions known for opaque corporate registries like the PRC?
 - The Government is currently in the market research phase, the approach to evaluating and prioritizing features is still under development. The program office may prioritize the ability to uncover Ultimate Beneficial Owners (UBOs) through layered corporate structures. Considerations may be relevant for platforms that demonstrate the capability to penetrate five or more layers of ownership, particularly in high-risk jurisdictions with opaque registries (e.g., PRC, offshore havens) may be relevant as this is critical for identifying hidden control and illicit financial flows tied to transnational criminal organizations (TCOs). The evaluation criteria will be provided if a solicitation is issued.
2. Will the platform be required to automatically flag State-Owned Enterprise (SOE) influence and 'Military-Civil Fusion' linkages, even when that ownership is indirect or held through minority stakes?
 - Yes, the platform should automatically flag State-Owned Enterprise (SOE) involvement and Military-Civil Fusion linkages, even when ownership is indirect or minority-based. Detection models should incorporate risk indicators beyond simple ownership percentages, including governance influence, board affiliations, and strategic sector alignment.

3. Does the DEA require the ability to trace both direct and indirect state ownership through multiple corporate layers, applying specific control thresholds (e.g., 50% or more) as defined in the RFI?
 - DEA will require the ability to trace both direct and indirect ownership across multiple layers. Platforms should support configurable control thresholds (e.g., $\geq 50\%$) while also allowing analysts to identify influence below that threshold when risk indicators justify further scrutiny.

Entity Resolution and Data Integrity

4. Given the high volume of spelling variations and aliases used by transnational criminal organizations, will the technical evaluation include a 'blind test' for entity resolution accuracy across diverse languages and character sets?
 - The Government is currently in the market research phase, the approach to evaluating and prioritizing features is still under development. The technical evaluations may consider blind testing to be relevant to assess entity resolution accuracy across languages, aliases, and transliteration variations is essential for countering TCO tactics that rely on identity obfuscation. The evaluation criteria will be provided if a solicitation is issued.
5. Will the DEA prioritize solutions that offer a 'provenance trail' for every data point, ensuring that analysts can trace every risk flag back to a specific, original source document?
 - The Government is currently in the market research phase, the approach to evaluating and prioritizing features is still under development. The program office may consider solutions that provide a full provenance trail for all data points. Analysts must be able to trace each risk flag back to its original source document to support evidentiary standards and legal defensibility. The evaluation criteria will be provided if a solicitation is issued.
6. How will the Government evaluate the quality of 'derived' vs 'declared' data to ensure that entity fusion does not lead to false positives in high-stakes investigations?
 - The Government is currently in the market research phase, the approach to evaluating and prioritizing features is still under development. The Government may evaluate how platforms distinguish and validate 'derived' (inferred) versus 'declared' (source-reported) data. High-quality solutions should clearly label both, apply confidence scoring, and minimize false

positives through transparent methodologies and auditability. The evaluation criteria will be provided if a solicitation is issued.

Supply Chain and Network Visualization

7. Does the requirement for 'Multi-Tier Mapping' specifically include the ability to visualize the flow of capital and ownership alongside the physical flow of goods, to identify where financial risk propagates across the supply chain?
 - Yes, multi-tier mapping should include both ownership/capital flows and physical goods movement. This dual-visibility is essential to identify where financial risk intersects with supply chain activity, especially for narcotics precursors and illicit trade.
8. Will preference be given to platforms that can map suppliers of suppliers, specifically for manufacturers based in regions with high concentrations of chemical precursor production?
 - The Government is currently in the market research phase, the approach to evaluating and prioritizing features is still under development. The program office may consider platforms capable of mapping second- and third-tier suppliers. This may be relevant for identifying upstream sources in regions known for chemical precursor production and diversion. The evaluation criteria will be provided if a solicitation is issued.
9. The RFI mentions a need for 'facility-to-facility' transaction coverage; will the Government prioritize data depth at the manufacturing site level over broad, high-level port-to-port logistics data?
 - The Government is currently in the market research phase, the approach to evaluating and prioritizing features is still under development. The program office may prioritize depth at the facility level when it directly supports investigative objectives. While high-level logistics data may be relevant, actionable intelligence often requires site-specific insights (e.g., manufacturing nodes, storage locations). The evaluation criteria will be provided if a solicitation is issued.

Federated Architecture and Collaboration

10. Regarding the 'federated architecture' for public-private collaboration, is the goal for the platform to provide a common operating picture where the Government and private sector can cross-reference findings against a shared knowledge graph without exposing sensitive business data?

- Yes, the goal is to enable a shared operational picture between government and private sector partners via a federated architecture. This should allow cross-referencing of intelligence against a shared knowledge graph while preserving data ownership and protecting sensitive business information.
11. How much weight will be given to the platform's ability to facilitate live, multi-agency collaboration on a single 'Case ID' while maintaining strict role-based access controls (RBAC)?
- The Government is currently in the market research phase, the approach to evaluating and prioritizing features is still under development. The program office may consider platforms that support real-time, multi-agency collaboration tied to a single Case ID. Strict role-based access controls (RBAC) may be relevant to ensure data segmentation, operational security, and compliance with legal authorities. Evaluation criteria will be provided if a solicitation is issued.